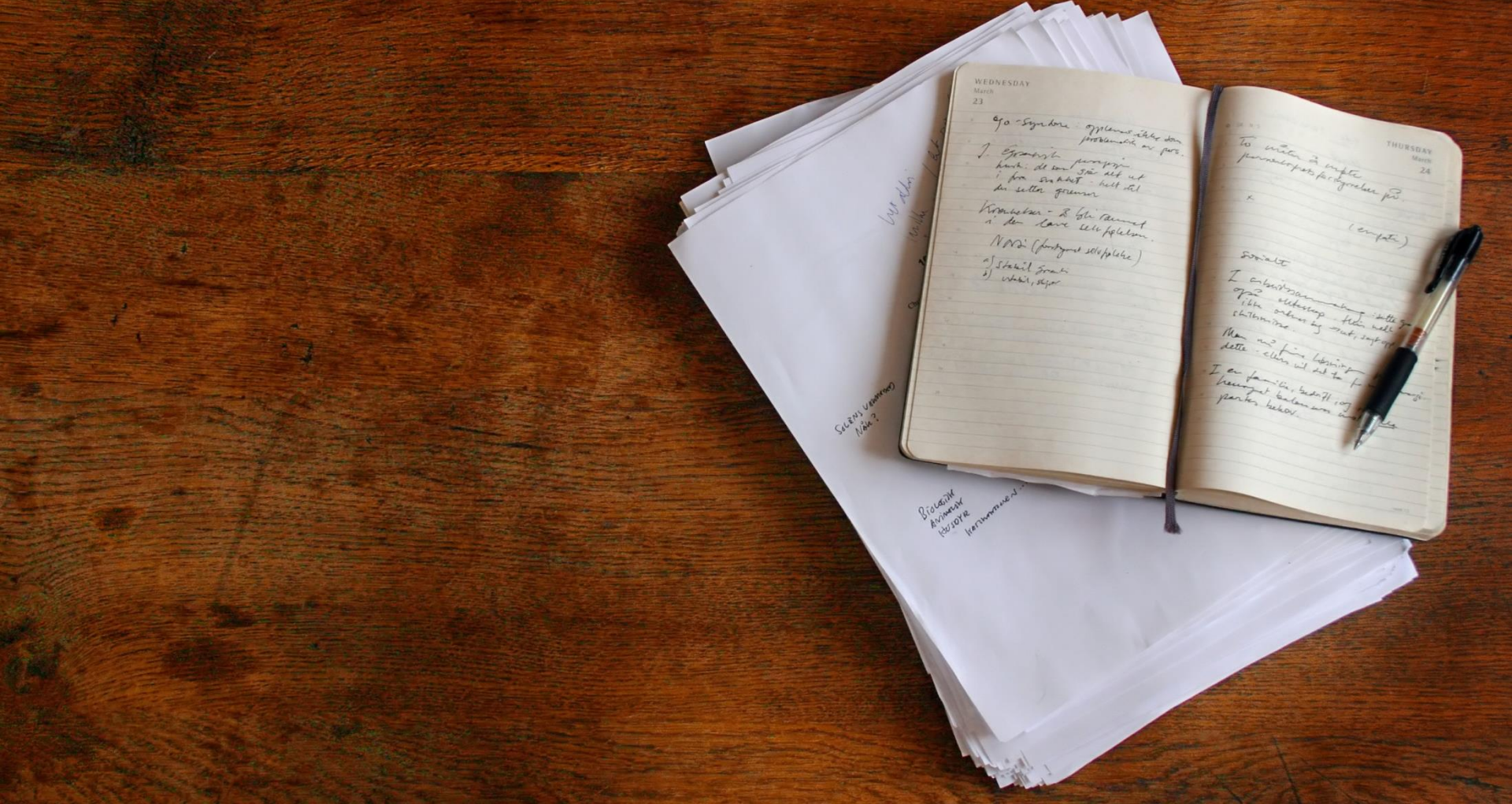




# ACADEMIC WRITING (BETA) WEEK 7, LECTURE

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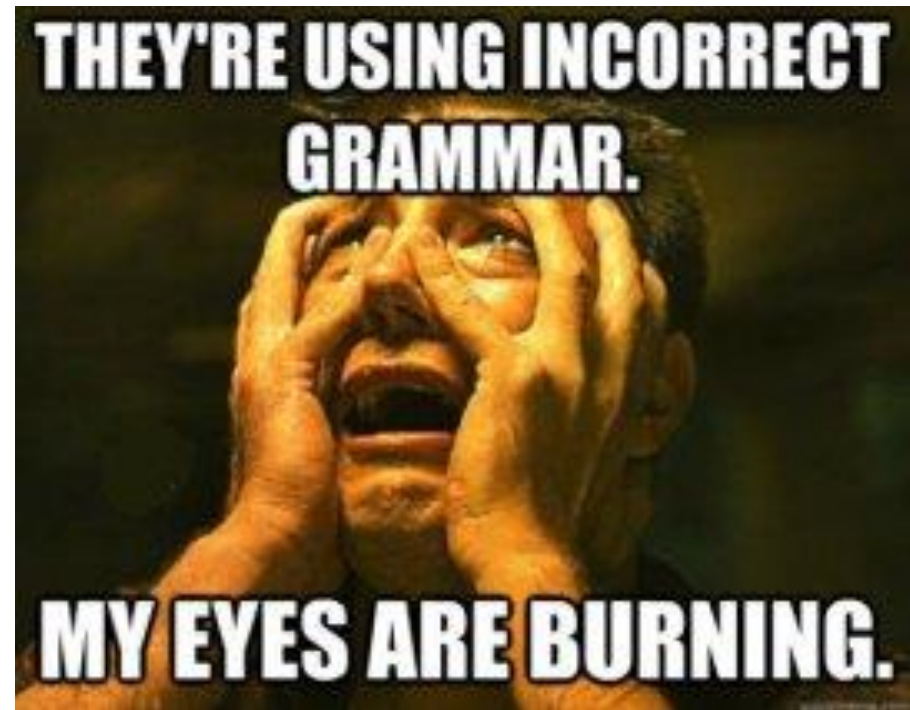




# FRAME FOR TODAY'S DISCUSSION

Different perspectives on language use:

- Standard grammar rules
- Prescriptivism (*thou shalt not...*)
- Conventions (making the right language choices within a given context, making the right impression, fitting in)



# EXAMPLES OF 'THOU SHALT NOT'

Do not end your sentence with a preposition:

- The dress had not even been paid **for**.

Do not split infinitives

- She used to **secretly** admire him.



# WHAT KIND OF ENGLISH?

# WHAT TYPE OF ENGLISH?

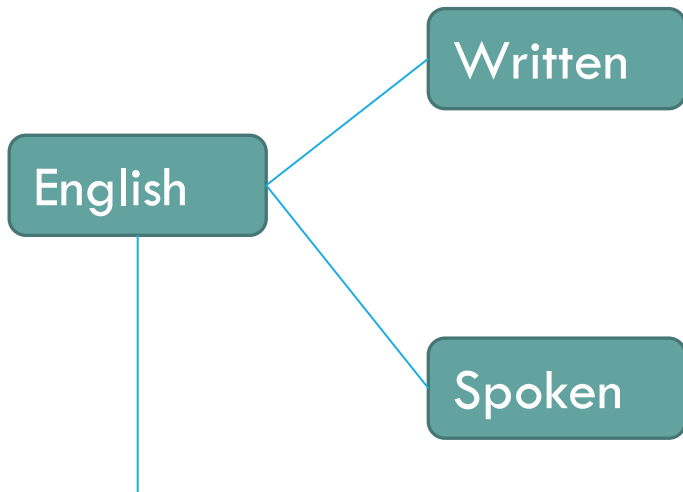
English

# WHAT TYPE OF ENGLISH?

English

- British
- American
- International?
- Academic?

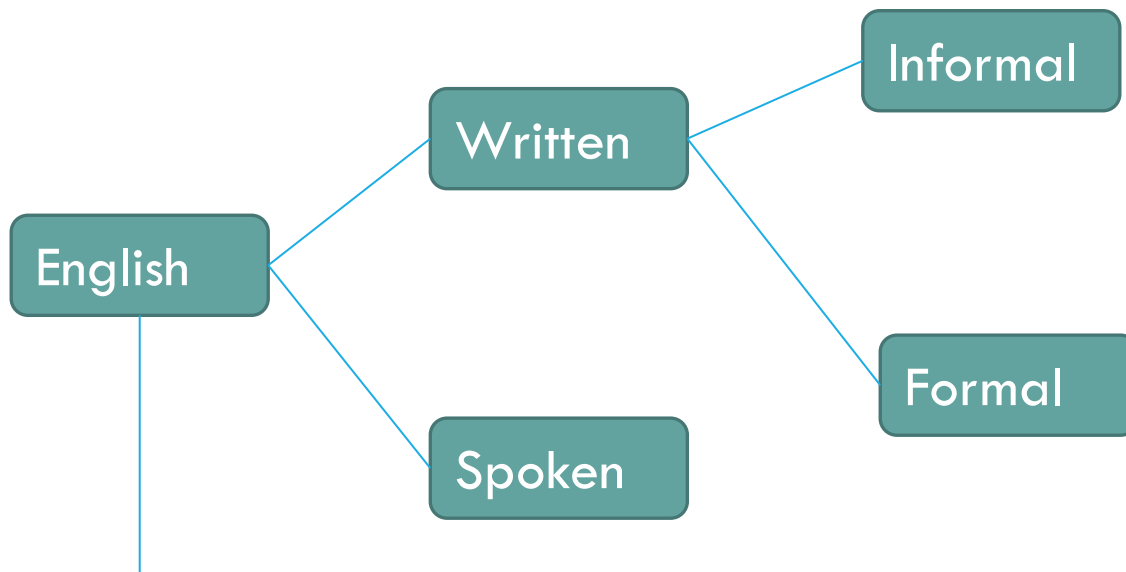
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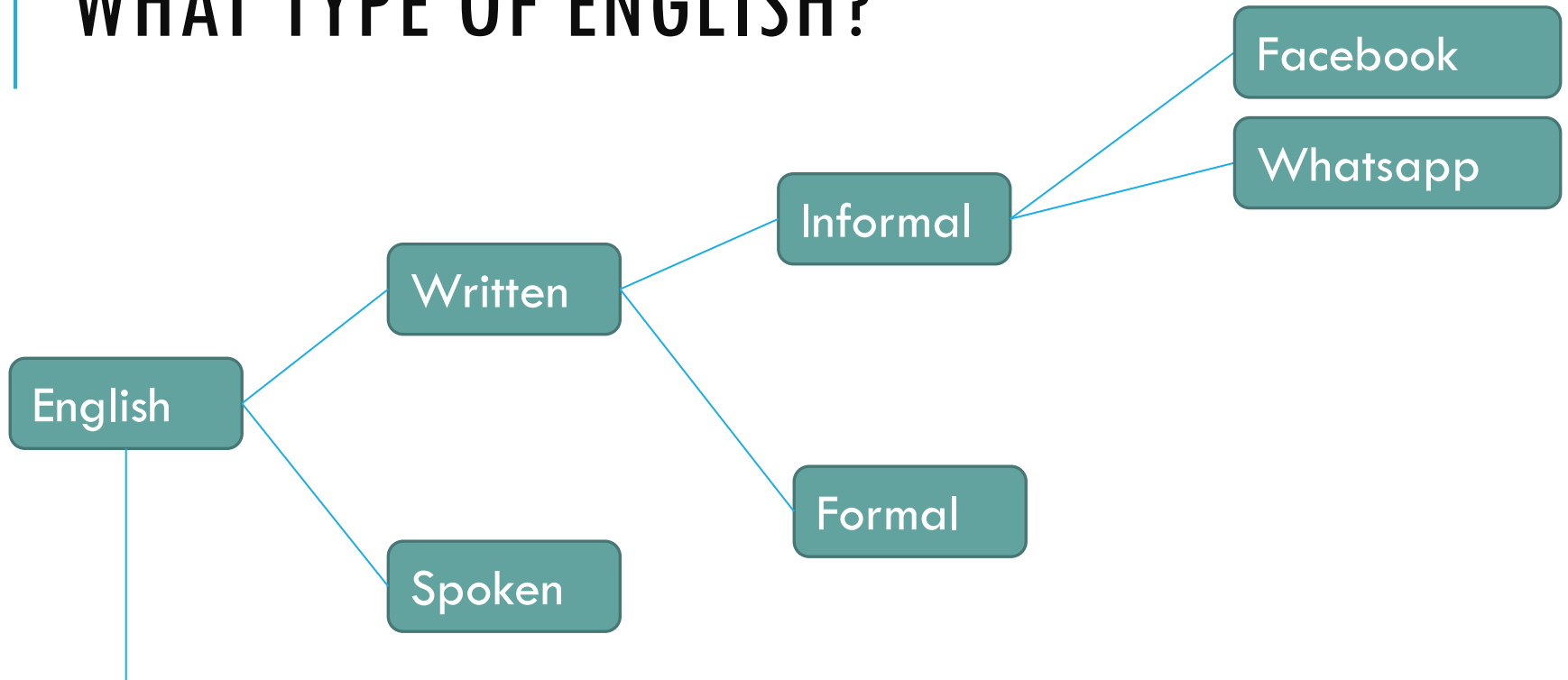


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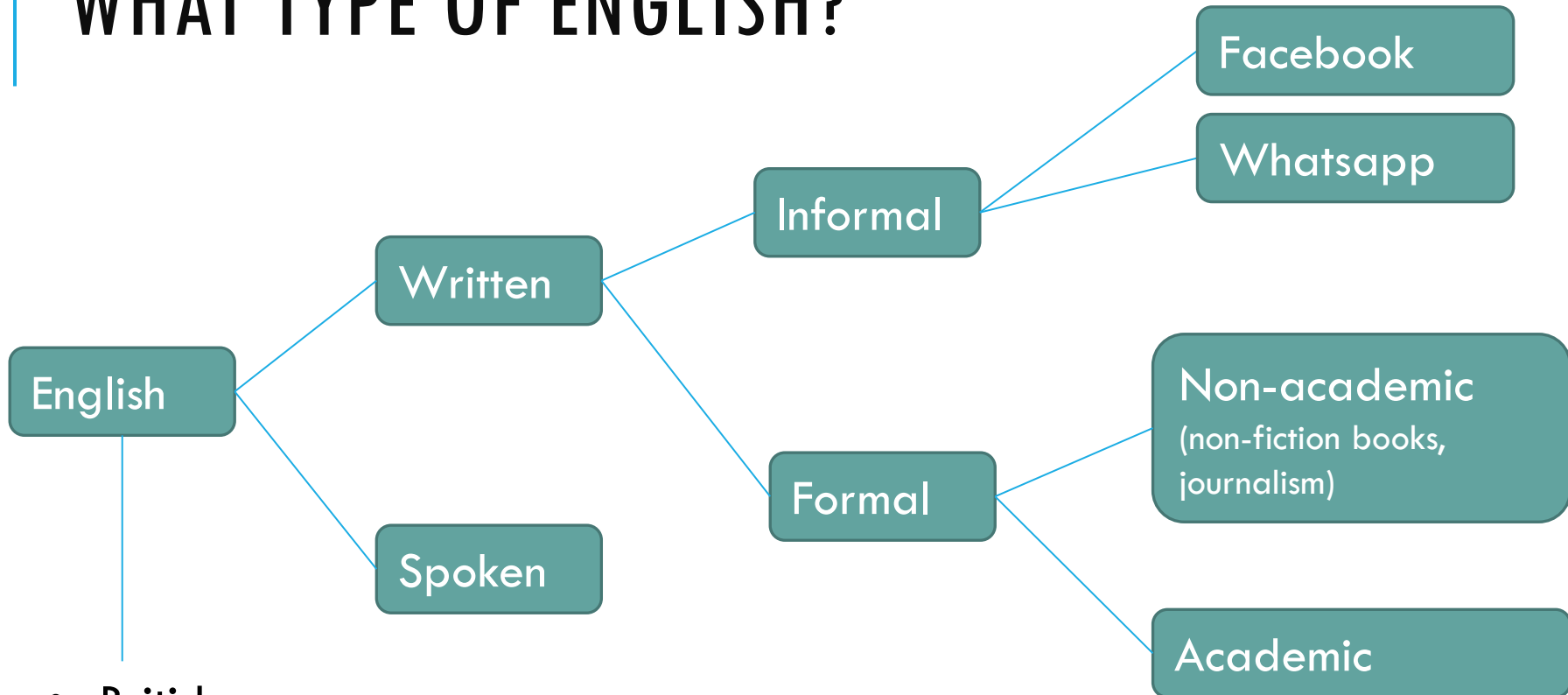
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**DON'TS (AKA: CTRL+F!)**

# 1. VERB CONTRACTIONS

*won't*

*hasn't*

*isn't*

*we'll*

*I'll*

*it's*

*can't*

*shan't*

*won't've*

*could've*

*couldn't've*

*they'd've*

A clear feature of spoken/informal language, so avoid



# 1. VERB CONTRACTIONS (CONT'D)

Note: possessive 's IS allowed

- *Smith's proposal for innovation.*
- *\*Smith his proposal for innovation.*
- *In Jones's study, a distinction is made between X and Y.*
- *\*In Jones his study, a distinction is made between X and Y.*

(\* indicates incorrect examples)

## 2. YOU

- Never use in academic writing.
- Why not?
  - Too informal, too direct (impolite)
  - Too vague: who is you?
    - *You can see in table x.*
    - *When you write a text, you need to make sure that it is correct.*

# AVOIDING YOU

- In this table you can see that the costs increase
  - > Table 2 shows that the costs increase.
- You cannot know when a printer will fail.
  - > The time that a printer will fail cannot be predicted.
- If you want to calculate ..., you need to do ....
  - > In order to calculate..., it is necessary to...

# SHORT TASK: REWRITE THESE SENTENCES

An example of a cloud used for data storage is Dropbox. **You** can upload all of **your** data to Dropbox and they host it for **you**, which means that **you** copy **your** data on their servers and **you** can access them from anywhere over the internet.

A query is a request for information. When typing just a letter or just a word in Google, **you** will automatically see some possible search suggestions and those are called queries

# SHORT TASK: REWRITE THESE SENTENCES

An example of a cloud used for data storage is Dropbox. Users can upload their data to Dropbox and Dropbox hosts it for them, which means that users copy their data on the Dropbox servers and they can access them from anywhere over the internet.

A query is a request for information. When typing just a letter or just a word in Google, some possible search suggestions will automatically appear and those are called queries

### 3. FRAGMENTS

Each sentence should contain 'someone/something does something' (in grammatical terms: a subject and a finite verb)

1. This as a result of influence from the Sydney School.
2. The main point being that the boards of companies tend to be corrupt.
3. The number of years of instruction and hours of extracurricular lessons correlated with second language learners' oral performance (Muñoz, 2014). Although this correlation was weak.
4. Despite the major developments needed for the electric vehicles, there are several advantages, some of which even contribute to these developments. For instance the development of batteries.

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### 3. FRAGMENTS

1. This **was the result of** influence from the Sydney School.
2. The main point **is** that the boards of companies tend to be corrupt.
3. The number of years of instruction and hours of extracurricular lessons correlated with second language learners' oral performance (Muñoz, 2014), **although this correlation was weak.**
4. Despite the major developments needed for the electric vehicles, there are several advantages, some of which even contribute to these developments, **for instance the development of batteries.**

## 4. AGGRESSIVE PUNCTUATION

1. The risks of amphetamine use are: restlessness, dizziness, headaches, palpitations and hallucinations.
2. For example: amphetamines can cause palpitations.
3. The outcome? A lack of resolve!

## 4. AGGRESSIVE PUNCTUATION

1. The risks of amphetamine use are [:] restlessness, dizziness, headaches, palpitations and hallucinations.
2. For example, amphetamines can cause palpitations.
3. The outcome was a lack of resolve.



# DO'S

# 1. REPLACE INFORMAL AND VAGUE WORDS WITH FORMAL AND PRECISE ONES

**stuff:** effects, equipment, gear, goods, individual, kit, luggage, objects, paraphernalia, possessions, substances

**a lot of:**

abundant, adequate, considerable, substantial, sufficient, significant, many/much

**things:** aspects, areas, elements, facts, figures, materials, points, situation, subject, information

# WORDS TO LOOK OUT FOR

- Verbs describing aims
  - Not *look at*, but *investigate*, *aim*, *examine*...
- Reporting verbs:
  - not *says*, but *discusses*, *argues*, *proposes*...
- Two-word verbs
  - *put off* - *postpone*
  - *look into* - *investigate*
  - *come across* - *discover*

# IN THE SAME CATEGORY

- We
  - Who is 'we' anyway?
    - *Me and my co-author(s)*
    - *You, me and everyone else*
    - *You and me*
    - *me*
- *Get > obtain, be, acquire...*

## 2. USE IMPERSONAL WAYS OF BEING PERSONAL

- I think this is the best solution.

Clearly, this solution provides the best option for...

Not surprisingly, many critics have concluded that ...

It is not likely that...

It is generally accepted that...

It is clear that ...



# A WORD OF CAUTION

In witness whereof the parties hereunto have set their hands to these presents as a deed on the day month and year hereinbefore mentioned.

vs

Signed on (DATE) .....

### 3. USE STANDARD ACADEMIC PHRASES

- Be an active reader: how do authors in your field describe aims, transitions, personal opinions, critiques?
- Use the *Manchester Academic Phrasebank* for inspiration (examples on the next slides)

## Indicating the focus, aim, argument of a short paper

In this paper, I argue that ...

This paper attempts to show that ...

The central thesis of this paper is that ...

In the pages that follow, it will be argued that ...

In this essay, I attempt to defend the view that ...

The aim of this essay is to explore the relationship between ...

The purpose of this paper is to review recent research into the ...

This paper

argues that ...

gives an account of ...

discusses the case of ...

analyses the impact of ...

attempts to show that ...

contests the claim that ...

provides an overview of ...

reviews the evidence for ...

reports on a study which ...

traces the development of ...

explores the ways in which ...

assesses the significance of ...

highlights the importance of ...

considers the implications of ...

critically examines the view that ...

proposes a new methodology for ...

examines the relationship between ...

compares the different ways in which ...

investigates the factors that determine ...

describes the design and implementation of ...

## **Being cautious when discussing implications or recommendations**

One possible implication of this is that ...

The findings of this study suggest that ...

The evidence from this study suggests that ...

Taken together, these results suggest that ...

The data reported here appear to support the assumption that ...

Initial observations suggest that there may be a link between ...

The findings from these studies suggest that X can have an effect on ...

Strategies to enhance X might involve ...

Other types of response could include: a), b). ...

These results would seem to suggest that the ...

There would therefore seem to be a definite need for ...

A reasonable approach to tackle this issue could be to ...

Another possible area of future research would be to investigate why ...

## Indicating significance

This research sheds new light on ...

This study provides new insights into ...

The study offers some important insights into ...

The present study fills a gap in the literature by ...

Understanding the link between X and Y will help ...

This investigation will enhance our understanding of ...

This is the first study to undertake a longitudinal analysis of ...

The present research explores, for the first time, the effects of ...

The findings should make an important contribution to the field of ....

This study provides an exciting opportunity to advance our knowledge of ...

This study aims to contribute to this growing area of research by exploring ...

This project provided an important opportunity to advance the understanding of ...

Therefore, this study makes a major contribution to research on X by demonstrating ...

There are several important areas where this study makes an original contribution to ...

## Indicating limitations

The thesis does not engage with ...

This study is unable to encompass the entire ...

It is beyond the scope of this study to examine the ...

A full discussion of X lies beyond the scope of this study.

The reader should bear in mind that the study is based on ...

Another potential problem is that the scope of my thesis may be too broad.

Due to practical constraints, this paper cannot provide a comprehensive review of...

# COMING UP NEXT

- This week: seminars as usual
- Next week: Friday 23 May, deadline for assignment 4
- Make sure you read the instructions for assignment 4 on Canvas **very carefully** (you don't want to lose points because of requirements that you've overlooked)

# YOUR TIPS AND TOPS FOR US

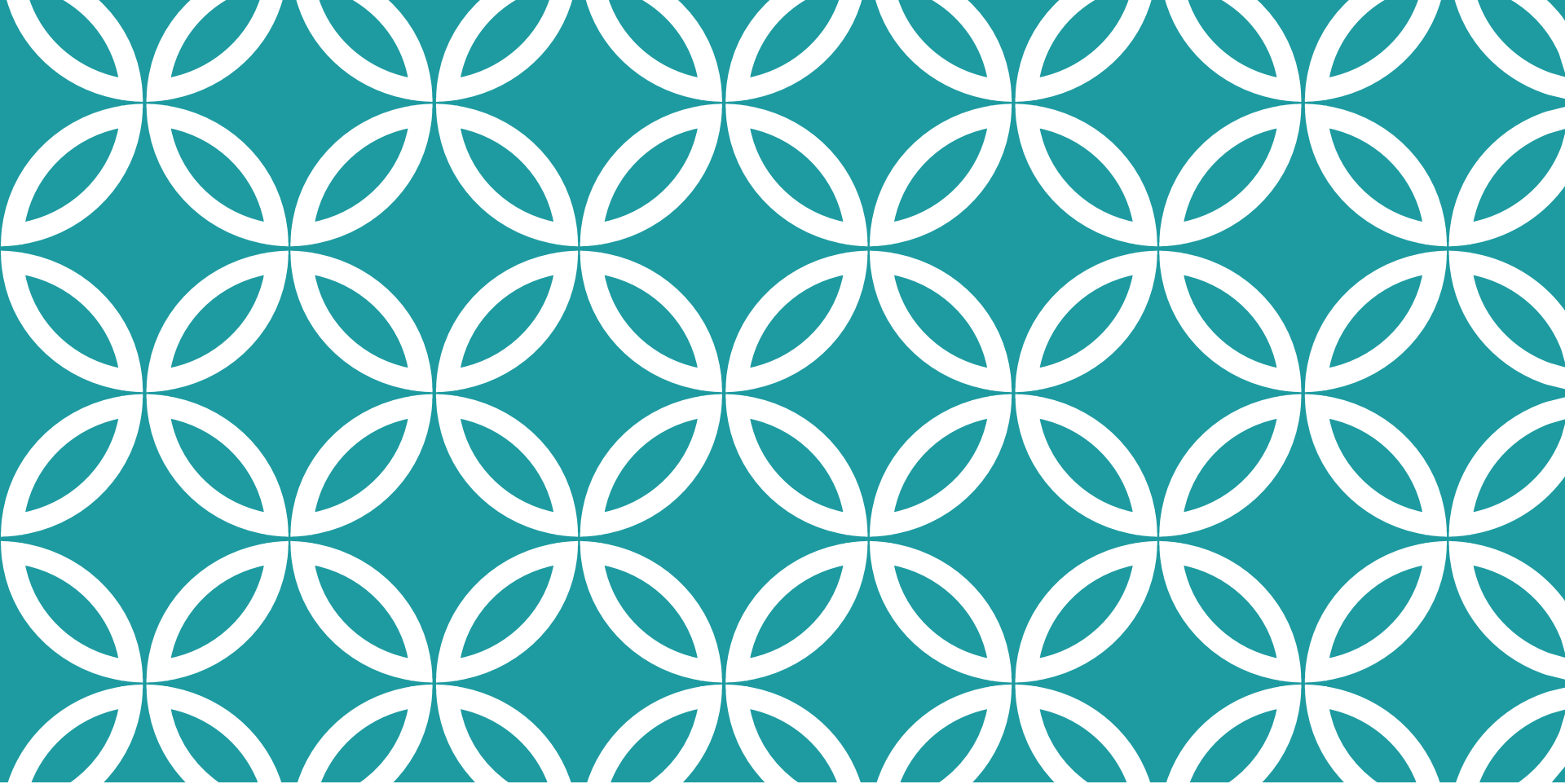


Menti

BETA lecture 7



Choose a slide to present



**GOOD LUCK WITH YOUR FINAL  
ESSAY!**

